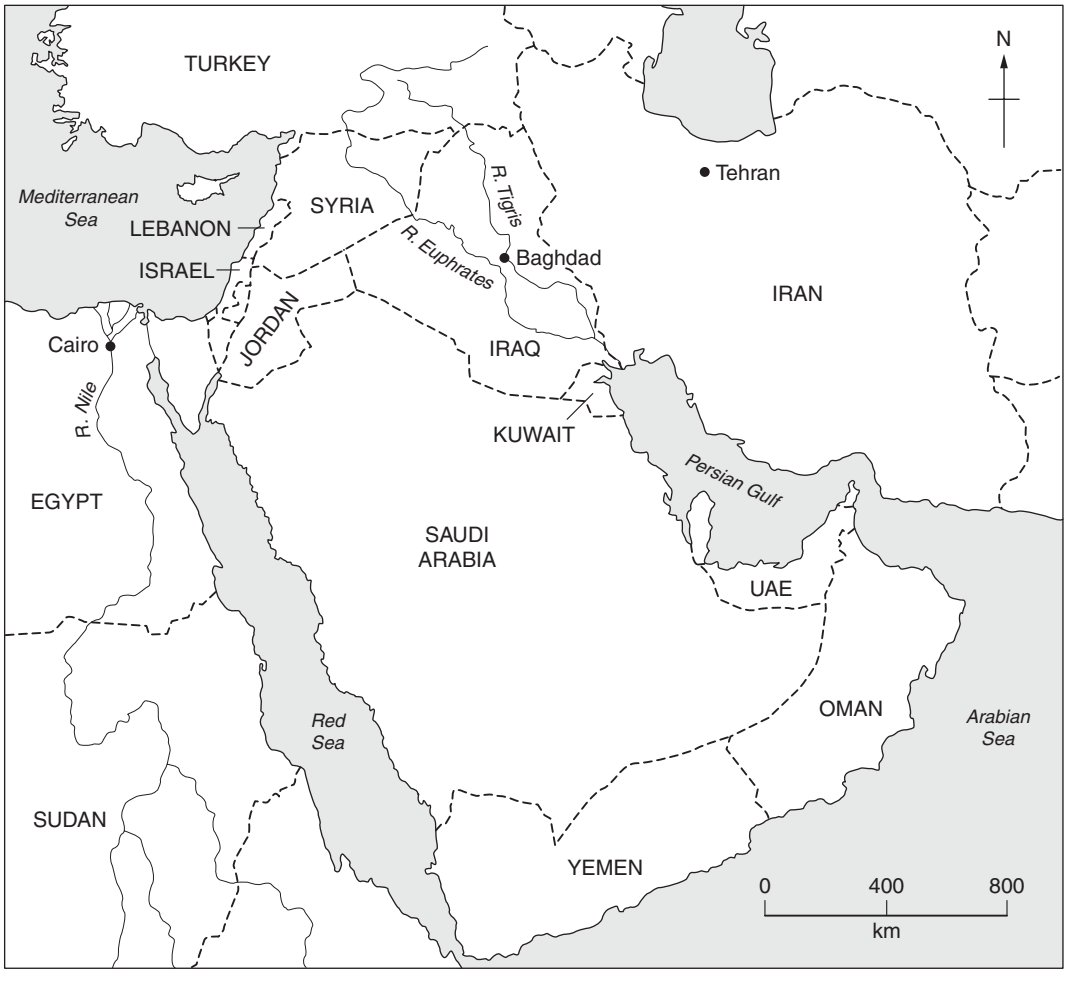
Introduction: The Scope of the Book

The term 'Middle East' is commonly used to refer to the area incorporating Israel and surrounding Arab states. It includes the countries that share borders with Israel – Egypt, Jordan, Syria and Lebanon – and countries such as Iraq and Saudi Arabia. Iran is not usually included because it is further east and because it is not Arab or Arabic speaking. However, it is included in Chapter 7 of this book because, in the past 30 years, it has had a big impact on the politics of the region.



The Middle East today.